

# ACTIVITY 3: Reading: Studies in Happiness.

You are going to read four texts to studies on happiness. From questions 1- 10 choose from the studies (A-D). The students may be chosen more than once. You also have to indicate in the text the answers and quote them.

## Which student:

1. focuses on an understanding of choices?  
**D:** Instead of focusing on wealth, researchers advocate focusing on things that bring deep personal fulfilment...
2. says people's happiness can be marred by their surroundings?  
**A:** The two places have comparable levels of prosperity, but Rutland happens to be situated near an area of outstanding natural beauty characterised by wonderful lakes, and its citizens have better and easier access to the natural environment.
3. presents contradictory findings for one group of subjects?  
**C:** The study also took gender into account; both the happiest and unhappiest groups were girls.
4. talks about the obstacles in the way of happiness for adults?  
**D:** Increasingly, more people face hardships such as reduced incomes and longer working hours, so it may seem counter- productive to try to incorporate more happiness into a person's life.
5. contrasts different metropolitan districts?  
**A:** One comparison involved the citizens of Wokingham and those of Rutland, both located in England
6. proves the need for a certain level of material wealth?  
**B:** Recent findings in the US show that families with annual incomes of around \$75,000 register the highest levels of emotional well- being.
7. allows a certain group of people to justify their actions?  
**C:** Such news should empower parents who can now refuse to hand over money for mobile phones or video games in the knowledge that such a policy really is for their children's own good.
8. mentions an ongoing change in the structure of society?  
**D:** Even though many western societies have progressed enormously over the past few decades, unhappiness is at an all- time high. This seems to be because too

much emphasis has been placed on material possessions.

9. says that high living standards have an impact on emotional well-being?

**B:** While a larger income may be required in order to lead the privileged lifestyle available in urban areas, thus reducing overall disposable income, the extra luxuries - access to world- class venues, for example - offset the added expense.

10. suggests that being in close proximity to large numbers of people may negatively affect happiness?

**A:** The town is more densely populated than Rutland with fewer parks to help alleviate stress and the pressures of everyday life.